GRADE 3

Curriculum Book

Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 3 - Curriculum Book

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

For: *the grown-ups in a 3rd-grader's life — parents, guardians, grandparents, caregivers.* ***Read time:*** *6 minutes.*

Where ideas come from

Skills, hobbies, needs - and the eyes to notice.

What your child is learning this year

"You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?"

- CASH, GRADE 3

This year your child's class is learning that **business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs.** They will:

- Map their own skills, hobbies, and needs they notice.
- Form a trio with named roles (CEO, designer, money keeper, sales).

- Generate five business ideas from one problem and pick the strongest with a written reason.
- Do whole-number cost / revenue / profit math on a hypothetical lemonade stand.
- Draw a logo and choose a name for their business idea.
- List the steps of running a business in order.
- Sort claims into honest and misleading.
- Reflect on what a "first try" got wrong, and one fix.

The host is **Cash** — a coin-shaped mascot who appears in eight short videos across the year. Cash never says "amazing!" or "you're a star!" Cash says: "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

How this connects to home

> TRY THIS
>
> **Spot it in the wild**
>
> Walk through your house. Find three things somebody made or sold. Write the name of one. Who do you think bought it, and why?

Your child does not need to run a real business. The default is a paper version — a "Skill-and-Need Stand" they design on paper across the year and present on Capstone Day in June.

What helps at home:

- **Notice their skills out loud.** "*You always remember when the dog needs water. That's a skill.*" Most 8-year-olds don't yet have words for what they're good at. You can give them the words.
- **Take their idea seriously the first time.** When your child says, "*I want to start a business that finds lost pencils,*" don't laugh. Ask: "*Whose*

pencils get lost? How would you know if kids actually want this?" That is the year's whole muscle.

- **Skip the money question.** Your child's teacher will not ask about your household budget. Please don't volunteer it either. The math in this curriculum uses a *hypothetical* lemonade can that costs $4, not your real grocery prices. That's on purpose.

One good question per quarter

WORDS TO KNOW

Skill
Something you have practiced enough to be good at.

Hobby
Something you do for fun, on your own time.

Need
A problem somebody has that they want solved.

Customer
The person who pays - not the person you wish would pay.

Idea
A skill, a hobby, or a need turned into a way to help someone.

Each quarter, ask your child this one question. That's it. Don't grade the answer. Just listen.

Quarter 1 (Weeks 1–9): Skills, hobbies, needs

> CASH SAYS
>
> "*What's something you can do that another kid in your class might not know how to do?*"

If they say "nothing," try: "*What does your teacher last year say you were good at?*" or "*What do you do every day that I don't have to remind you about?*" Something will land.

Quarter 2 (Weeks 10–18): Five ideas from one problem

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*What was your trio's idea this week, and why did you pick it over the others?*"

Listen for the *reason.* If the answer is "*because it's a good idea,*" gently ask: "*What makes it good — your skill, the need, or that kids would actually use it?*" Those are the three reason types Cash teaches.

Quarter 3 (Weeks 19–27): The lemonade math

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*If your trio's lemonade can costs $4 and you sold 16 cups for $1 each, how much money is left at the end?*"

Right answer: $12. Wrong answers are fine — ask them to walk you through it. The point is them explaining out loud what *cost, revenue,* and *profit* mean.

Quarter 4 (Weeks 28–36): Run, honest, fix

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*What's one thing you'd change about your trio's stand if you ran it again next month?*"

Listen for the *fix.* This is the year's most important reflection. "*We'd lower the price.*" "*We'd add a sign that's bigger.*" "*We'd take turns at the table.*" Any specific fix counts.

What to watch for

> **MATH MOMENT**
>
> **Tally five**
>
> Ask five people: 'Would you buy this?' Tally yes and no with marks. Five marks each row. Did more say yes or no?

Good signs

- Your child uses the words **customer · problem · plan · profit** at the dinner table.
- Your child says "*my evidence is* _____" even informally.
- Your child argues with a sibling about whether a TV ad is *honest* or *misleading.*
- Your child names their trio's roles by name.

Things to nudge gently

- "*I have nothing*" — about skills. Push back: every kid in this curriculum has at least one. Help them see it.
- "*Everyone will buy it*" — overstatement. Ask: "*Who's the first one?*"
- "*My trio doesn't listen to me*" — common in the trio. Ask: "*What is your role? What is theirs?*" Roles are protection.
- "*This is boring*" — usually means stuck on Lesson 6 (the math). Sit with them on the cost/revenue/profit worksheet for 10 minutes. The trick is one number at a time.

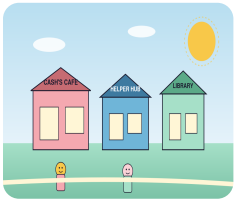
Things to flag for the teacher

- Your child saying nobody on the trio listens to them after 4+ weeks.
- A trio idea that surfaces real social conflict (a stand that names a kid as the "problem").
- Math that won't click after Lesson 6 — the standard (3.OA.D.8) is on grade and there's a coaching plan in the Teacher Guide.

Capstone Day (Week 36)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real customers

Family, neighbors, classmates, teachers, the person at the corner store. Five real people beats one good guess.

In June, the class hosts Capstone Day. Each trio sets up a 3-foot table with their logo, their cost/revenue/profit numbers, their run-of-day list, and a 90-second pitch. Families and a guest classroom (often Grade 4) walk the room and ask one question per stand.

Your child will:

- Wear or share a role label (CEO, designer, money keeper, sales).
- Give the 90-second pitch (sales has the notecard).
- Answer one visitor question.
- Show the artifacts.

You will:

- Get 3 sticky dots when you arrive. Use them at any stand: "*I would buy this,*" "*I learned something,*" "*Honest claim.*"
- Ask **one** question. Make it a real one. "*Who's your first customer?*" "*What did your first try get wrong?*" are excellent. "*Are you going to be a millionaire?*" is not.

If you can't visit: the teacher will record the pitch and share via the class platform. There's also a make-up window in Week 37.

Sensitivity — what we won't ask your child

> FAMILY TALK
>
> **Skill, hobby, or need?**
>
> At dinner, name one skill, one hobby, and one need somebody at the table has. Could any of them turn into a tiny business?

Cash to Company is careful about money. We will **never** ask your child:

- How much your family spends on groceries, lemonade, or anything else.
- What your family income is.
- What your family pays for the things at home.
- Whether they have a particular subscription or membership.

If your child volunteers any of this at home or at school, that's a normal kid moment. The curriculum does not require it. The math in class uses a *hypothetical lemonade stand* with a $4 can — invented numbers on purpose.

We also will **not** tell your child that wealth is purely a matter of mindset, that anyone can be a millionaire, or that hard work guarantees success. That isn't honest. Cash celebrates the move — making the artifact, doing the math, drawing the logo, telling the truth, fixing the flop — not the win.

Where this is going

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

Grade 3 is the first year of the upper-elementary band. Grade 4 picks up exactly where this year leaves off. The Grade 4 question is *who buys, how much, how many, what does it cost me, and what's left?* Your child already knows the *what's left* answer by June. That's profit — and that's the year.

Grades 5–8 layer on pricing strategies, customer research, and break-even math. Grades 9–12 build full business plans and, for some students, real ventures. The whole arc is built so a student who starts in Grade 3 has the language and the muscles by Grade 12 to make a real Launch-or-Learn decision about a real venture.

Two final notes

1. **You don't have to be a business person.** You don't have to start a business with your child. You don't have to know what a contribution margin is. The most useful thing you can do is listen, ask one good question per quarter, and notice your child's skills out loud.
2. **The point is the move, not the win.** Some trios will sell zero pretend cups on Capstone Day. Some will "sell" all of theirs. Both did the year. Both made the artifact, did the math, told the truth, and made a fix. That is what we celebrate. Cash means it: *first tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*

If you have questions during the year, the teacher will answer them at conferences and in any of the unit-launch communications. You're welcome at the classroom door anytime.

Welcome to the year.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Three dinner-table prompts (Grade 3)

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

These take 60 seconds each and require nothing of the parent.

Prompt 1 — Hobbies into businesses

You: "*What's a hobby you have? What if a business was built on that hobby?*" Child: *(thinks; maybe says "I love drawing")* You: "*What would the business be?*" Child: *(makes drawings to sell, teaches drawing, draws portraits, illustrates books, designs T-shirts)*

You don't need to evaluate. You just need to ask.

Prompt 2 — A problem you could solve

You: "*What's a problem you keep noticing in our neighborhood?*" Child: *(answers — the corner is dark at night, the playground has no shade, the bus stop is muddy)* You: "*What kind of business could fix that?*"

Prompt 3 — Profit, plain

You: "*If you sold one of [your hobby thing] for $5, and it cost you $2 to make it, what's profit?*" Child: "*$3.*" You: "*Yes. Now if you sold ten — what's the math?*"

You're modeling profit as a real adult thing your kid can do. Don't grade their answer; just ask.

One thing NOT to ask

Don't ask "*how much do you think Mom and Dad spend on...*" — that's a curriculum-rule violation. The curriculum keeps family money private. So do these prompts.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 3)

Quarter 1 (Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web) 1. *At dinner:* "Whats one skill of yours that someone would pay for?" — Sample: "Im good at drawing dogs." — Follow-up: "Who would pay for that?" 2. *On a walk:* "Whats a hobby you have that could be a business?" — Sample: "Bird-watching." — Follow-up: "Who would pay you to take them bird-watching?" 3. *In the car:* "Whats one need you see in our neighborhood?" — Sample: "Theres no place to get a cold drink in summer." — Follow-up: "Could a kid fix that?"

Quarter 2 (Lemonade Math: Cost, Revenue, Profit) 1. *At a real lemonade stand or sale:* "What does it cost them to make this?" — Follow-up: "Whats their profit on each one?" 2. *In the kitchen:* "If we sold these cookies, what would they cost us?" — Follow-up: "What price would we charge to make $1 each?" 3. *Drive-time:* "If you sold 5 lemonades at $1 each and the lemons cost $2, whats your profit?" — Follow-up: "What if you sold 10?"

Quarter 3 (Logo + Name + 3-Person Trio) 1. *At dinner:* "If you started a business, whats your name and logo?" — Follow-up: "What does the logo tell the customer?" 2. *Watching a TV show:* "Wheres the logo on that store? What does it look like?" — Follow-up: "Why that color?" 3. *On a walk:* "Lets pick three jobs for a kids business — CEO, designer, money keeper. Which would you want?" — Follow-up: "Why?"

Quarter 4 (Honest vs. Misleading) 1. *Watching a kids commercial:* "Was that ad honest, or did it stretch the truth?" — Follow-up: "How could you tell?" 2. *In a store:* "100% juice vs. juice drink — whats the difference?" — Follow-up: "Which one is the customer expecting?" 3. *At bedtime:* "Whats one thing in a Cash story you remember? What did the entrepreneur fix?"

Sensitivity: None of these require parents to share home finances or business expertise. They work for any family.

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash will never say to your child: "Amazing!" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Just believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks instead: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?"

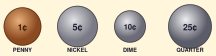
Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, some hustle-bro coded. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, never selling.

One question this year: "*Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?*" If your child can name one, the program is landing.

FROM CASH

What I do, what I love, what I notice

Three questions. Three sentences. Three ideas. That's how a business starts - not with a logo, with a list.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 3 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Spending and saving - earning money, choices, opportunity cost.

CEE NS3
Productive resources, scarcity, and choice.

CCSS-MATH 3.MD
Measurement and data - survey customers, tally results.

CCSS-ELA SL.3.1
Engage in collaborative discussions - pitch and feedback.

CASEL Self-Awareness
Identify strengths, interests, and values.

C3 D2.Eco.1.3-5
Compare benefits and costs of choices.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? — Cash

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